

THE
WELLINGTON
WHITE

DIARY

Fort Wayne, Oct. 25th, 1861

Today, being the day to leave Fort Wayne, we were up at an early hour and then every one was busy in packing up what few things were allowed a soldier. We were packing up to leave home and friends. Our tents and baggage was all packed and are now ready to start at sun rise. We took the boats for Detroit and left Detroit at 12 o'clock on the Mich Central RR. Had a very pleasant ride. Were greeted at all the depots by brave men and fair ladies and were lead to think that Michigan could spare a few soldiers for the cause of freedom.

We arrived at Niles about 7PM. Here the friends of freedom had prepared some refreshments of biscuits and butter with hot coffee that suited our taste for better than waving handkerchiefs. We rode all night over the prairies of Indiana and at daylight we were at Lafayette. We saw nothing of interest. The country looked as though it was not in good land. The houses were poor, fences down and a great deal of timber land. The people did not look like New England folks. We got to Indianapolis about 12 o'clock Saturday noon. There was a part of an Indiana regiment encamped. We stopped and got some coffee. Concluded by the way the folks charged for this stuff, that they liked money better than they did us. We left here and arrived at Jeffersonville just after dark. And as they had made no preparations for us, we had to stay in the cars all night. We were tired and hungry and did not like the plan of being pinned up all night. As there was not room to sleep in the cars, I sought a bed in a freight car on a load of corn. It was cold and I caught a bad cold. At 2 o'clock, we were called up and started for camp on the banks of the Ohio. We got our tents up and the camp in good shape to live and then got orders to be ready to march in ½ hour notice. I retired to bed for the first time in my life on the ground. I did not sleep much. The camp was all confusion; the soldiers receiving their orders. At 2 o'clock Sunday morn, we were called up and ordered to pack up and be off as soon as possible.

Nov. 6th, 1861

Very windy in the morning but mild and warm. Very pleasant and warm all day. Got a paper from G.J. Hitchcock. Better than nothing. Played an hour in the evening. Went to bed. Some tired.

Nov. 7th

Another fine morning. Feel first rate with the exception of sore lips by blowing too hard. Visited the hospital this morning. A sad looking place. It's a hard case to be sick in the army. Poor Hathaway is pretty sick. Looks as though he would like to see home and mother. Got a letter from "Sis". It makes the others jealous to have letters when they expect one. 6 o'clock PM. The camp's full of rumors that there is 10,000 rebels only 15 miles from us and approaching all gap I guess. The regiment is employed on clearing the hill for fortifying. The hill is about 200 ft high and it's fun for the boys to fell the big trees down the bank. Some of them go to the bottom with a loud crash, tearing up trees and stones in their way down and they arrive at the bottom without a limb on their trunks.

Nov. 8th

Very pleasant this morning. We have orders to pack up and move our camp to the other side of Salt River. All is confusion and commotion. 6 o'clock PM. We have got moved. Our tents are up and we have got a fine place for our camp. The day has been very warm. So warm that the shade looks inviting. Today we hear that General Buckner has been reinforced. If so, it's possible we may have trouble with them. 9:00- It looks like rain. Lightning in the northwest.

November 9th Saturday

Quite rainy, thunder, lightning and rained all night. Our tents stand the tempest well, although quite damp. The poor fellows on guard had a dubious time last night. The clouds cleared away and we have had a pleasant day. Have had some addition to our forces. The Ohio 1st and 18th regiments joined us. Also a regiment of cavalry from Indiana. Got a letter from Owosso. Nothing better than a letter from friends, unless it is two.

November 10th Sunday

A little foggy in the morning but cleared away and we have a pleasant day. Felt a little unwell this morning. Went to church in the AM; had a very good discourse. Visited the hospital. There are about 125 sick. Poor fellows look sad.

November 11th Monday

A very pleasant day. So warm that we have to throw off our coats. Had a smart thundershower last night. The Ohio regiments practiced in firing. Commenced to take the Louisville Journal.

November 12th Tuesday

Another warm, pleasant day. A good deal too warm for comfort. Went to the river to do a week's washing. Quite a novelty for sure. Don't think I shall take in washing for a living. Guess that belongs to the sphere of women. Came near to being shot while washing. Someone on the opposite side of the Ohio fired a ball, which struck the bank about 20 ft. from us. We concluded we would not wash any longer.

November 13th Wednesday

Had rather an exciting time last night. We retired to bed as usual and before we got to sleep the picket guards fired an alarm. At once the whole camp was up in arms. The drums were beating, bugles sounding, officers shouting, "turn out, turn out". Picket guards were firing and occasionally a ball would whistle over our heads. The regiment was formed, drawn up in line of battle. The cavalry came dashing by us upon the keen gallop and we expected every minute the rebels would make a charge upon us. Some were frightened about to death and others took the occasion to get off an extra volley of oaths. But it was soon discovered to be a false alarm. So all turned in. But not to sleep. For in less than half an hour, we were again wanted by the pickets, discharging their pieces more respectfully than before. We all thought now there must be something up. We went through the same performance as before and sooner than I can write it, 4000 men were armed, equipped and in line of battle, quietly waiting an approaching foe. But no foe appeared and the alarm was pronounced false. With our hearts beating lighter, we again turned in. But as before not to sleep. For we were again to be routed and not only a third but a fourth time. We were called out to meet a bloody foe but we were not permitted to see any foe in any shape. We finally got to bed at 2:00 and were not disturbed again. The cause of all the alarm is not known.

November 14th Thursday

Cloudy and rainy in the morning. Had a heavy rain in the night. Had the unspeakable pleasure of sleeping all night. Rainy all night, so we could not go out to practice. Bought me a revolver. One of Colt's best. Think I shall be able to defend myself now.

November 15th Friday

A little cooler this morning. Our neighbors, the Ohio 1st and 18th, Indiana 37th and the cavalry left us this morning. They go in fine spirits. We have got to stay here to defend this post. A regiment of infantry from Wisconsin arrived here last night. Got a letter from Phronia this morning. That's alright. We bid the boys in the Indiana 37th goodbye. They played us a tune and we played for them. Was sorry to part with them. Would like to go along with them. Had a chance to get outside the camp. Practiced firing my gun. It is a hard looking country. It is at least 40 years behind the times; both the inhabitants and the improvements. Corn seems to grow well. The largest I ever saw is here. The stalks are at least 20 ft. high. The ears are as high as I can reach. The timber is black walnut, beech, elm, oak. There is no pine or spruce.

November 16th Saturday

Pleasant but cool. Had a white frost last night. It came very near getting inside of our tent. If I don't succeed in getting another blanket, the frost will get inside. In the afternoon, went up on the hill to see the fortifications. The hill is about 250 ft. high and they are throwing up breast works and firing cannons. They have 8 pieces now and more are coming. It will be a strong position I think. We shall find no difficulty in holding it against any force the rebels may bring against us. We found on the hill the mistletoe growing. It grows in bunches upon other trees. It presents a curious appearance. After the leaves are all off the trees, the mistletoe is still green and is now covered with small white berries which look like white currants. They look very beautiful.

November 17th Sunday

Cool and cloudy. Light frost last night. Went to church in the AM. Sermon preached from Romans 1st, 18th. Met an old friend in the Wisconsin 1st. One I'd not seen for 13 years. Of course I was glad to see him. It seems good to see anyone, that I have ever seen before. Spent the evening with Captain Newcombe.

November 18th Monday

Were routed out at 5:00. Had orders to strike our tents and move up on the mountain. Carried our tents up on our backs. Had a great time getting up with the baggage. Concluded that mule teams wanted mule drivers. We finally got our things all up the hill and our tents up. Got a letter from AMW. An amusing incident occurred today. That is, amusing to us little folks. When the soldiers were all at work carrying the tents up the mountain, one 2nd lieutenant began to swear at the orderly because he had not sent his tent up. The orderly told him he would when there were any of the boys at liberty. The lieutenant told him there were two privates doing nothing. The orderly told him two were not enough. The lieutenant said two was a great plenty. Just then the 1st lieutenant stepped up and the orderly says if two is enough to carry it, suppose you two carry it up. And then the 1st lieutenant took a part and the 2nd lieutenant the other and up they went not stopping to rest till they got to the top.

November 19th Tuesday

Pleasant but cool. The wind blew hard all night. I thought the tent would blow over, but it stood it bravely. Spent the day in fixing up the camp. Made some bedsteads. They are made with a dull axe out of hickory rails and look very nice.

November 20th Wednesday

Pleasant. Some warmer. Practiced all day. Got some papers from Owosso. Spent the evening with Captain Newcombe.

November 21st Thursday

Another pleasant day. Worked today building a furnace to warm our tent. Had a hard job carrying a large stone up the hill for the top of our furnace. Our furnace is a novel one made by digging a hole in the center of the tent and covering it with a large flat stone for the smoke to escape. We dig a trench from the fire to the outside of the tent and covered that with flat stones for a chimney. We used a barrel with both heads cut out. To all appearances, it will work well, but am not certain. Time will tell.

November 22nd Friday

Quite rainy. It is days like this that put us in a disagreeable face to camp life, with no shelter except our little tents. Nothing outside but sticking, slippery mud. Have to get and eat our meals in the rain or go without. An extremity which I do not like to resort to. It is days like this that make a soldier think of comfortable houses or a nice warm shop and if he does not wish himself there, he certainly will wish the war was over. Here we are, 5 of us in a little tent, 8X10. One is fiddling, two are eating hard bread, one is asleep, being a little sleepy. Having slept only 12 hours last night, I find I get more sleep than I am use to, being obliged to go to bed 8 ½ o'clock.

November 23rd Saturday

Quite cold. Ground froze quite hard. The wind blew hard all night. Expected to see the old tent go over all night but it stood out the gale. Very windy all day. The ground did not thaw all day in the shade. Our mountain home is not quite so pleasant. Such windy weather. But we all felt good at night, for we drew another blanket each. So now, we can sleep warm. If we cannot keep warm through the day. Got a letter from Fisher, Mass.

November 24th Sunday

Cool and windy. Cloudy. Occasionally, a snow squall. Very uncomfortable. Frost does not last all day. This makes me think of the comforts of home. Would like to sit down to a good dinner inside of a house or get a chance to go to church in a meeting house or sit down and enjoy a good evenings chat amongst folks. Finally, I'm getting a little blue but never mind the pay master is here. Perhaps, he will make me feel better. Wild geese and ducks are flying over going south to keep warm. Should like to go along with them. Wonder what the folks are all doing at home. Wonder how long before the cook will get that "hard bread" ready for dinner. If some of the boys don't make up a fire, I shall have to or else freeze I guess. Anyway, wonder how it would seem to get warm. Don't believe it would hurt a fellow much. 3:00-Called out to dress parade. So cold, that the valves of our horns would freeze when we stopped playing. Should think Kentucky was North instead of South. Spent the morning at Captain Newcombe's quarters. Water froze all day in the shade

November 25th Monday

Got up quite early this morning. Was glad to see that the weather had moderated some. Quite cool. The cook is sick and we have to get our own breakfast. Tough business though. Thought I'd get some coffee. Found the sugar all gone. Went to get some potatoes, found them all froze. Looked for a clean plate, found every dish dirty. But finally succeeding in getting some sugar and some coffee, beefsteak, and hard bread. Pronounced it good. Got my horn and went to play at guard mounting. 10:00-The boys are being paid off. It makes them feel good. The fullest companies out this morning that I've seen for a month. Received a letter from sister EM. Filled with the same good common sense, good advice, and tender sympathy which a true hearted woman always writes. What a world this would be, were it not for the sunlight shed from women. We can see a faint glimpse of what it would be all around us, were it not for the restraint of the fairer sex. We see what we never would see. One is forced to believe if he did not believe before, that man was not made to be alone. It wants the smooth hand of women to brush away the hard rough inclinations of man. But for fear, some of the ladies will get hold of this, I stop without saying more. I got a letter also from F.D. Next to a soldier's pay comes letters from home. They remove the blues if he is unfortunate enough to have them. They are far better than medicine. Went to serenade at the colonel's quarters in the evening. Got a compliment from the pay master. He invited us in and treated us to the cigars and old bourbon. Neither of which I had any use for.

November 26th Tuesday

A little warmer. Some signs of a storm. Not feeling very good. Slight headache. We received our pay this morning. I drew pay for only 18 days. \$20.49. Spent the morning with Doolittle.

November 27th Wednesday

Quite wet. Rained all night. Feel better than I did yesterday. All right. Had an invitation for a Thanksgiving dinner tomorrow. Think I'll accept the invitation.

November 28th Thursday Thanksgiving

Another rainy day. Thought I should have to give up our dinner but it cleared away and we left the mountain for the world below. 1:00. Seated in the sitting room at the hotel. It seemed good to sit down in a chair in a house. Wish they would hurry up. Those turkey dinners ready. How it looks to see a white table cloth and other things in preparation. Well as you might suppose, we did justice to all before us. After dinner, the colonel proposed a toast One which he thought we all could join in hastily. This is it, "sweethearts and wives". It was drunk in silence, but we all thought of those far away.

November 29th Friday

Pleasant in the morning. Had a hard rain last night. The wind blew a hurricane and the rain poured down in torrents The wind blew over several tents, thus leaving the boys to the mercy of the storm. Our tent leaked badly. Got some wet. Commenced to build us a house to dine in and use to practice in. The sides are to be made of rails, cover boards hooked from a fence. We have to carry the rails and boards about half a mile on our backs. A hard job.

November 30th Saturday

Up before light this morning. Three inches of snow on the ground. Looks like winter surely. Commenced to shovel out the dirt for a cellar. Worked two hours before breakfast. After guard mounting, we had to pack one knapsack and get ready for review. If I had been at home, I should have thought it a bad job. The mud and water are about 4 inches deep. Had to march around and stand in the water about 4 hours for the officers to get through with the inspection. Got back and went to building. Worked hard all day. Pretty tired at night. The sun shone through the day and the snow pretty much disappeared. In other words turned to mud.

December 1st Sunday

Got up at revelry this morning. Had the unspeakable displeasure of being told that I must cook for the band. Carry me back. I can stand grief but cooking that's too much. Well here it goes. First I got a rail. Cut some wood. Made a fire. Got some water. Burned my finger with a kettle. Spilled a pail of hot water into one of the boy's shoes. Got some pork to frying. Set it all on fire. Went to grind some coffee, stepped on a slippery stick. Fell down and away went the coffee. Finally, got the breakfast ready. The boys thought it very good. After breakfast, went to washing dishes. Couldn't keep the water hot. Got out of all manner of patience. Concluded that dishwashing came into woman's sphere of action. Solemnly resolved, that if I ever get out of this scrape, I'll get a woman to wash dishes. Commenced to rain about 9:00 AM. Rained all day. Enough to make even a soldier homesick. Spent the evening with Captain Newcombe singing one of the Diapasons. It made me think of old times.

December 2nd Monday

The ground is covered with snow. Surely, winter is upon us and we have no houses. The inhabitants say there is more snow than they have seen for several years. We commenced on our house and got it up. So we had our supper inside. We find it pretty cold work playing outside on dress parade. The valves to our horns would freeze if we stopped playing a minute. Too cold to play in front of headquarters tonight. Snowed a little most all day. Thawed but a little.

December 3rd Tuesday

A fine morning. Some warmer. The trees on the hills are all frost. A heavy fog on them. Things look finely. Commenced easily to dig stones for our chimney. Had to carry them about half of a mile in our hands. Took us all day to build our chimney. Got it done and built a fire in the fireplace. Worked well. The whole regiment have orders to build them log houses. Our friends the Wisconsin 1st left us today. They met with a sad accident. One of the boys slipped down and his gun went off and shot a private next to him through the head and killed him instantly. We have got a new stove for our tent. It cost \$2.50. It is just the thing. Warms the tent finely. Seems good to have a place where we can warm ourselves.

December 4th Wednesday

Pleasant, cool and clear. Our hearts were sad this morning with the intelligence that one of our number was dead. Chamberlain is no more. 3 weeks ago, he was well and healthy. Now he is dead. Of the rest of us, who is the next to go. We have no better assurance of life than he had, 3 short weeks ago. Who will it be? Will it be me? This is a sad reality many of us that left home strong and healthy are never to return. Rec'd a letter from P. White. Also one from A V White. Do not feel very well today. So much wet weather I have taken cold. Be all right in the morning

December 5th Thurs.

Very pleasant. Quite warm. The snow all melted off. The mud grows deeper and if anything a little more slippery. Went down town to pay our last respects to our departed friend Chamberlain. We played a dirge while he was carried on board the boat and that is all we can do for him. It will be a sad blow for his folks at home. But such is war. So we are somewhat tired. We did not play at headquarters.

December 6th Friday

A beautiful morning. Warm and fine.. The birds are singing and the soft air is blowing. It seems like a spring morn. Went down town to see some of the sick at the hospital. They are all doing well. Will soon be with us. Were it not for the mud it would be very pleasant. But the mud seems to stay by us. Rec'd a letter from Matte Fremont.

December 7th Saturday

Another warm pleasant morning. It seems a little more like the sunny south than it did a week ago when it was so cold that water froze in the middle of the day. 6 o'clock PM-Just been to supper. Our cook has done the big thing. We had some doughnuts They were a first class article, best quality. To be brief, the best eating I have had since I left Detroit. I ate very hearty and am quite too full for utterance. But thought I must make a note of the doughnuts. Has the appearance of a storm. Begins to rain a little.

December 8th Sunday

Pleasant, air is warm and fresh as a May morning. Spent an hour this morning singing out of the diapason. went to church at 11 oclock There was but few out. Our reg't is not much given to church going. Sermon preached from Isaiah 42: 16. Went down town in the afternoon. The town is full of teams carrying store for the army. One would hardly think it was Sunday. Our cook has favored us again. We had some apple pie for supper.

December 9th Monday

Pleasant and warm. We enjoy this kind of weather. Can sit at evening with the tent open. The wind blowing in and not feel uncomfortably cold.

December 10th Tuesday

4 regt came down the river and so camped on the flats about a mile from us. They tried the cannon this morning. They fired about ½ mile. The balls went into the bank about 8 ft. Think there would be no trouble in killing a man that distance. 3 reg't crossed over the river this morning and one stopped on the other side. We went down town serenading in the evening. Serenaded Lt Hornbeck. He invited us in to a bountiful supper. Had a fine time. Went from there to Dr Geoghagan's. He met us with a hearty welcome and gratified our appetites with some fine apples. Invited us all to call again. Went from there to Widow Guthrie's where we met Lt. Fox, Dr. Church, and others. We were served in bountiful stile. Had a very pleasant time to say nothing of the blackberry cordial, old bourbon, several kinds of cakes, apples which made us "glad we came". It was a beautiful evening, so warm, that the doors were all open and every thing had the appearance of June. But as we came out of the house to go back to camp, we found it was raining. So we got a little wet and had a hard job getting up the hill. It was so slippery. The mud here being about 3 parts soap grease and 2 of dirt.

December 11th Wednesday

A very pleasant day. A little cooler. We commenced to build us a home I never expected to settle down in old Kentucky but it looks like it now. Rec'd a letter from AP W & wife. Sold my watch.

December 12th Thursday

Cool in the morning but a very pleasant day. Commenced to build us a house. Concluded we might as well settle down in old kentuck as any where. Our house is to be 10x 12 ft. About half underground and the other half is composed of boards.

December 13th Friday

Another very pleasant day The weather for the past 3 weeks fill my idea of the sunny south. We commenced early on our house. Got it most done. Went downtown to get some nails. Had a chat with a couple of the fair ones of Kentuck. Received a letter from ? Full of fine things. Does a soldier good to get a letter from a true and worthy friend. Another regiment arrived here today. the Ohio 10th. They are a fine regiment on their way south.

December 14th Saturday

The Ohio 10th strike their tents and leave for the south. Finished our house. Going to occupy it tonight. The boys are busy building shantys. It is a rural place. We have 50 or 60 houses and no two alike. Some are made of logs entire, some of boards, some of both logs and boards, and some of mud on the whole. It is a fine looking city of about 800 inhabitants. just at dark a boat passed here with a regiment on board. The band were playing Yankee Doodle, Hail Columbia. It was too dark to see who they were.

December 15th Sunday

Pleasant and warm. Not a cloud to be seen. Went to church in the AM but few out. All too busy writing home. Had dress parade in the PM. The most out that there has been for a month. Got moved into our new house. Find it very nice. We feel as proud of it as a little boy with a new whistle.

December 16th Monday

The weather still continues fine. The boys have to take off their coats to work or drill. Went downtown. Went down on the flats to dress parade. Honest Riley had one grand slide in going down the steep bank. It being muddy and slippery, his feet got in a great hurry and started in advance of the more prominent part leaving him on his own resources, much to the amusement of the rest of us. Our leaders thought he did not look just right to march down the lines, so he sent him back to camp. We have the most delightful evenings I ever enjoyed. The air daft and balmy as an evening in June. Doolittle and I promenaded the breastworks around the Fort and only wished that we had company more congenial to our feelings to make us perfectly happy.

December 17th Tuesday

Warm and pleasant. Old winter is wearing off and we have warm weather. Our camp is visited by Ladies most every day. Today some 5 or 6 took dinner with the Colonel. We went down to play for them. We have the most beautiful evenings one ever dreamt of. Well calculated to inspire a poet with sublime thoughts and emotions.

December 18th Wednesday

Still warm and pleasant with some signs of a storm. Received a letter from Henry, Gregory, and Willie. They are the same attentive ones as ever. They wrote me a good letter.

December 19th Thursday

Little cooler but very pleasant. Our regiment is improving finely. The sick are getting well. We have all got our houses built so we can devote the whole time to drilling. We had quite a number of distinguished visitors today. They took quite an interest in the battalion drill and dress parade. They made some remarks to the officers. They were well pleased with the performance. We got some knapsacks. They are a fine thing and we feel as pleased with them as a little boy with a new whistle. Tommy thought he should sit up all night to wear his. Another thought he would sleep with his on.

December 20th Friday

Cloudy and windy in the morning but the clouds cleared away and we got no rain. Went down on the flats to battalion drill and dress parade. The farmers are plowing, the ground being in good order to work. Went out to serenade some of the officers in the evening. Captain Newcombe and Lieutenant Bangs and Marble did the fair thing by inviting us in and treating us to some very nice cake just from Michigan. The boys could appreciate the cake quite as well as the generosity of the donors. The first piece of good cake we have had since we left Michigan. Quite a rarity.

December 21st Saturday

Quite cold, some cloudy. So cold that the valves to our horns would freeze as soon as one stopped playing at guard mounting. We find the cold creeping into our shanties in various little air holes. So we set ourselves to work at corking. It begins to look like winter, cold and ruff.

December 22nd Sunday

Cold and rainy. A dull, dark, muddy lonesome day. Cannot step outside the hut without drawing at least one acre of bounty land and inside our hut it is not much better. Wish we had father's barnyard to live in. It would be so nice, compared with what we have here. Deliver me from Kentucky mud. Had to turn out and bring in wood on our backs, to cook with. Rather tough on the American people. We found with all our pains, that our house leaks some. But by keeping our rubber blankets on our beds, we can keep dry. It is a rather ruff living. Makes one feel a little blue. But it's a little consoling to know that we are as well off as any of the regts,

December 23rd Monday

Quite cold all day. Cloudy and windy. We played at guard mounting. At least tried to. So cold our horns would freeze if we stopped blowing. Did not attempt to play any more all day. Sat around and read newspapers which I red'd from Owosso. Got the blues slightly.

December 24th Tuesday

Got up at breakfast call. Cloudy but not quite as cold as yesterday. Got a slight cold, headache. Went after wood and slipped down on the frozen ground and sprained my wrist. Too cold to practice out of doors. Had a good practice in the big hut! Went on dress parade as tomorrow is

Christmas. There is no drill or dress parade. The boys are to have a holiday. At 7 o'clock PM the long roll was beaten and the bugle call "to arms" was sounded. Firing was heard in the direction of our pickets and men turned out on the double-quick, assembled inside the fort, and the cannons loaded. The firing continued and we thought there were some mischief in the wind. We would all stop and hold our breath to listen and catch some distant sound. But after waiting for an hour, the scouts returned and said the pickets had not fired a gun. It was the darkeys, contraband celebrating Christmas. We of course, were glad it was not some enemy, and laid aside our war implements and went back to bed.

December 25th Wednesday Christmas

Warm and pleasant. Got up at breakfast call. After breakfast went to guard mounting. That being over the day was to ourselves. I went out and met Captain Newcombe and Lieutenant Barrows and Marbles. They invited me to a walk in the country to practice shooting, see the wonders of nature. At the foot of the hill we met the quartermaster and through his kindness we obtained some horses to ride. After waiting for the horses to be curried and saddled we mounted and started over the paved road. My horse proved to be not a very easy trotter. But to make up for that defect he was ambitious and on the race was not easily beaten. The road we took lie up a winding ravine between high hills on either side with a small stream of pure water, sometimes on one side and then on the other side. The scenery was beautiful. We amused ourselves sometimes by racing horses and sometimes by firing our revolvers at the icicles which hung from the rocks up the steep banks. Past several large and beautiful springs of water about 5 miles from camp. We came to a place where a small stream came out of a side of a ledge of rocks. The opening in the rock was about 4 feet high and 3 to 5 feet wide and as there was but little water we entered the cavern. We found no difficulty in going about 150 feet when the opening became too small for our comfort. As we retraced our steps the hole seemed to have been worn out by water where the rocks were soft. Now the walls are solid limestone sometimes worn smooth and then again left very rough and ragged. Having procured some specimen of stalactites we returned to daylight. A little farther on we came to a cave in the hill sufficiently large to admit a man standing. We followed this winding passage some 300 feet when it became too small for further progress. Some parts of this cave were very beautiful. The roof would be covered with stalactites and the floor with stalagmites and sometimes they would be joined together forming pillars to support the roof. The only accident that we had was a bat which the Captain found on my back. We were unable to get any choice relics as the cave being small and having frequent visitors. The best were taken away. Having satisfied one's curiosity underground we returned to the outer world, mounted our horses and started for camp. We enjoyed the ride very much. Passed several small plantations but the country shows the effects of slave labor, houses, barns, fences, are in a sad state, fast running down and was not the richness of the soil almost exhaustless that would have run out ere this.

We got back to camp feeling well paid as well as shook up. Found a Christmas dinner waiting for me which was devoured with a will. That being over we had an invitation down to a dinner and flag raising at Co. H.'s quarters. Had a fine time as well as fine cake and turkey. That being over we were invited out into the country by the Colonel and staff to serenade some families of quality. We were all shoved into a big U.S. wagon with four horses for a team. Past through West Point. Attempted to play but the road was so rough and the horses went so fast that we did not succeed in playing much. Were ferried over Salt River and then one road took us up the bank of the Ohio. The road is macadamized and in good condition. The scenery is beautiful. The broad Ohio moving

mystically along with now and then a noble steamer with it's big paddle which would seem to stir the water to the very bottom plowing up it's smooth surface leaving a long line of waves and foam on the water and a long a line of smoke and steam in the air behind. And showing the improvements that has been made since the days of flat boats. This is the very stream that Abraham Lincoln used to paddle the old flat boat on. We passed several fine farms or plantations I should call them, which are perfectly level, and run back from the river to the high lands some half a mile and sometimes farther. The labor is performed mostly by slaves, who appear contented and happy, especially if they can get "a little bourbon". We stopped at one where we met a very pleasant company and the Col and staff. We played several pieces and partook of some refreshments. The lady of the house favored us with some piano music and sang several pieces. It reminded us of home. Had a pleasant time. Went from there to Dr. Geoghegan's. Gave them a serenade. Were invited in and were favored with some egg nog which most of the boys appeared to enjoy well. Leaving them, we started back. At one place they got up and sent out a little contraband with a basket of cakes, for our enjoyment. It being quite dark, we saw but little returning. Got to the ferry but found no ferryman. But after waiting ½ hour, he got along and ferried us over and after being halted about a half dozen times by sentinels we got back to camp at 12 ½ o'clock quite tired and muddy.

Dec. 26th Thursday

Got up this morning at breakfast call. Feel the effect of my horseback ride. Am lame in every joint. Had to go after two pails of water the first thing, and then the cook was sick. So we had to go to guard mounting before breakfast. Quite warm and looks like rain. Mud very deep in the PM. It commenced to rain. No dress parade.

Dec. 27th Friday

Clear and cold. So cold our horns would freeze if we stopped playing. Too cold to go out and practice. Spent the evening with Capt. Newcombe. Wrote two letters. Heard cannons coming from the direction of Louisville.

Dec. 28th Saturday

Cold and some cloudy. After guard mounting did my weeks washing. Don't like the business very well. In the afternoon, we drew our dress suit of clothes -coat and pants. We of course, feel very grand. We shall stand up very straight when we march down the lines at dress parade, ha ha.

Dec. 29th Sunday

Sunday has again come around and finds us still on the hill. It is a lovely morning warm and pleasant. The little birds are singing. Old Buckner has retreated and every thing seems happy. We had a visit this morning from 2 ladies from the country. They were fine appearing ladies. Said they had 2 brothers in the army fighting for the stars and stripes. They thought we looked comfortable. There is heavy cannonading in the direction of Louisville. George is going to shave. Ha Ha. 5 minutes later Charlie is flourishing the raisor over his smooth face. Did not get to go to church. Had a pretty long day. Rec'd some things from Owosso. Amongst the rest was a splendid Night Cap. Magnificently worked on costly fabric of red, white, and blue. 3 cheers for the red, white, and blue. and 3 times for the donors. Well I put it on and started for Doolittle's quarters and found him enjoying the same blessing. Well twas Sunday night but we did indulge in a little fun. I know it

isn't expected soldiers to say any useless things or be anything but steady boys but we thought the occasion required a little extra so we went in for it.

We appeared at dress parade with our new suit; felt grand 7 ½ dollar dress coats, goodness gracious ! This is doing very well.

Dec. 30th Monday

Very pleasant and quite warm. Don't feel very well today. Our new clothes were a little too much for us but we must get used to such things.

Dec. 31st Tuesday

Pleasant and warm. 2 years ago today I was at Niagara Falls. The coldest day I ever saw. Today is dress parade. So we are up, dressed in our Sunday clothes, boots blacked, napsacks packed, and slung, and off for the parade ground. Inspection is a long dull job. Got through at half past one, tired and hungry. Got a letter from ?? Spent the evening with Doolittle. This is the last call of the year. 1861 is past, the year is sealed up with its deeds of good and evil. How does my account stand? The judgment day alone will reveal the doings of the year.

January 1st 1862 Wednesday

Another year is begun. New books are opened. The first leaf is written on. What changes must take place before the close of the year? Many is the "Happy New Year" that is heard on every side. Will it be a Happy Year? How many hearts will be made sad ere this year is gone? Spent the day very pleasantly. In the PM went out into the country with Doolittle. Had a fine walk. Got back and found the boys all ready to go down town and serenade Major Fox and Lautz at Mrs. Guthrie's. So I turned around and went back with them. We played several pieces. Were invited in. Had a social time. Got an invitation for tea this night week. Came back to camp quite tired.

Jan. 2nd Thursday

A little cooler. Some signs of a storm. Had an invitation to a wedding out in the country. Fixed up and went. They had a large party. Did not succeed in seeing the knot tied. But was a fine looking bride any way. We played several pieces and had a splendid dinner. The table was loaded with everything ones appetite could crave. We thought we came to Kentucky to fight- but it certainly did not look very war-like at that house. Even Sambo and Aunt Dinah seemed to enjoy the occasion. We all agreed that we had a good time. Came back to camp quite satisfied. Commenced to rain in the evening.

Jan. 3rd Friday

Rainy all day. Quite cool. The rain froze as it fell, making it quite slippery. The reg't got orders to march in the morning. The boys feel good over the prospect of moving.

Jan. 4th Saturday

More were called up at 5 o'clock and then came the busy time. Every one busy with his own affairs. All our personal property was to be packed up etc. It seemed like leaving home as we had got our houses all in good order and were comfortable but we were not very sorry to leave. We got packed and left old Muldraugh Hill probably forever. We formed our lines on the flats at the foot of the hill. Had to wait some time for the men to all get ready. One of the boys got a bag of apples

from Mrs. Guthrie. While waiting we went and bid Mrs. Guthrie good-bye. She felt bad to have us leave. The tears ran down her cheeks as she bid us farewell. Saw several other ladies after waiting till we were tired of it. The word was given to march. So we bid farewell to West Point and Salt River and started South at 11 o'clock. Our progress was slow. The weather was cold. It had rained the night before and frozen. So it was quite slippery. We went 2 miles and halted at a beautiful spring of water to rest a few minutes. We then moved on. Passed through a beautiful ravine with a little stream of water by the side of the road. Saw but little to interest. There being no nice houses, no fine orchards, no improvements of any kind. We halted several times. Some of the boys got quite tired but we got as far as Bloomington and ? We pitched our tents and went to get straw which belonged to an old "secesh" He said he did not to spare any but our quartermaster told him he did not care a d___. Whether he wanted to or not he should probably take what he wanted to. So he dried up and we used his straw. Then we made some coffee for supper. Coffee and hard bread made our supper. Then being quite tired we turned in. 19 of us in one tent pretty thickly settled but we were soon asleep.

Jan. 5th Sunday

Were called up at 5 o'clock, then the first thing to do was to get breakfast. Coffee and hard bread for a change. We were bothered some to get our water hot and at last when it boiled we found a mouse in it. But as we did not want a meat breakfast, we left him, and got some more. Our breakfast over, we again struck our tents and started at 8 o'clock. It was still cold. The ground still frozen and fine walking. We started off in fine spirits. The scenery the same as the day before. Poor houses, no barns, neither a meeting house or a school house. The inhabitants being 2/3 darkeys which look more intelligent than their masters. At 12 we stopped to eat some hard bread and it commenced to rain and freeze which made it very uncomfortable but its all the same with soldiers. We trudged on and heard no complaint. I called at one house and found an old lady and a young man and wife. Had a long chat with them. The old lady thought the men north were lazier than the men south. She said she had never seen much of this world. She was 65 years old, was born 3 miles from there, and had never been any farther from home. We passed one fine mansion. It was located 20 or 30 rods from the road. In front was a very beautiful hedge and then between that and the house was beautiful walks and shade trees of all kinds. The house and the grounds showed plainly that its owners did stuff for cost here. We see here a great many thousands dollars expended that should have been scattered over the state in building school houses and meeting houses, etc. We arrived at our camping ground (1/2 mile from Elizabethtown) at 2 o'clock. Pitched our tents, got some coffee and hard bread and retired to bed early.

Jan. 6th Monday

Arose at daylight. Weather was cold and ruff. We got our coffee and hard bread and for a treat fried some pork. It is pretty ruff living. Felt a little blue. Thought I should be a little more comfortable at home. After breakfast went to Elizabethtown. It is quite a town. Some fine houses, and looks as though they do some business. Too cold to practice. And to make me feel good today, they set me to getting supper out in the cold. But not having much to get, I got along very well. Went to bed early.

Jan. 7th Tuesday

Cool and frosty. Got up at sergeant's call. Thought we would play at guard mounting. Had some

trouble keeping our horns from freezing After that we found the team ready to take our baggage to the other side of town. So we got some coffee and hard bread and packed up and then had to wait until 12 o'clock before we had orders to march. The reg't formed and we marched through the town playing 23. The whole town turned out to see us. The ladies greeted us by waving handkerchiefs and small flags. We arrived at our camping ground and pitched our tents. Got some more coffee and hard bread and were satisfied. Our camp is in a delightful place on a knoll at the foot at which runs a fine stream of clear water and just beyond runs the railroad. It looks good to see the cars again. Quite a number of trains pass here during the day and it really seems as though we had gotten into an enlightened land. We got our tents up about dark. Went out to play in the evening. Heard cannonading south of us. Hope they are reaching into secesh.

Jan. 8th Wednesday

Got up at daylight. Went out and found our darkey getting breakfast. Our own darkey that we hired of his master. So we northern boys have our own slave at work for us. Went to play at guard mounting after which we went out and got some straw. Had to go about 2 miles after it. Found a lot of black walnuts. Ate so many nearly got sick. Began to rain before we got back. Rained all the afternoon, but we have a nice tent that don't leak, so let it rain. Co. F got orders to start south in the morning to guard a bridge.

Jan. 9th Thursday

Still cloudy and raining. Mud very deep and pliable. Got excused from playing at guard and mounting, it being too muddy. Co. F struck their tents and take the cars. Sorry to part with them. Went to escort them to the depot. Got a letter from A.O. Went over to town. Bought a few articles. Quite a town. Quite a wet day. Sun has not shown in most of week. Played in the evening.

Jan. 10th Friday

Cloudy and wet. Do not feel very well. Shall be glad when the mud is all gone? Expected a letter. Did not get any. Why don't they write? The chaplain wants me to come stay with him. Think I will.

Jan. 11th Saturday

Still cloudy. After guard mounting got a pass and went to see the tunnel where the railroad runs through the mountain about $\frac{3}{4}$ of a mile, It is a great work blasted out of solid rock We went through. It was as dark as night inside. A train passed while we were in there. The roar of the train almost deafens one. There are 3 holes up to the surface to let the smoke escape. It is about 100 feet from the track to the top of the hill. We had to travel about 6 miles but felt well paid for the trouble. Too wet to go out and play. Rather dull but never mind the sun shines !good. It has shown before for about 10 days. Well, let it shine. The boys are trying to kick up a row in the band. They want to get disbanded. Getting homesick I reckon. Well they might as well dry up about disbanding, The thing can't be did.

Jan. 12th Sunday

Very windy and warm. So warm last night that we slept with the tent open all night. Went to church in the AM. Heard a very good sermon but few out besides our soldiers. Began to rain at noon. Quite wet all afternoon but in the evening came a change. The wind changed and I became cold fast. Rec'd a letter from C.C.W. Good one too. Wrote a letter to sister.

Jan. 13th Monday

Cold. The ground frozen quite hard. Yesterday morning the boys were bathing in the creek. This morning one shivers. It commenced snowing at noon. About 2 inches of snow fell. Looks like winter.

Jan. 14th Tuesday

Still cold but pleasant. Went over to town to get my boots fixed. Did not feel well in the PM. Had a bad headache. Played at dress parade. Almost froze. Went to bed early.

Jan. 15th Wednesday

Cold and rainy. Played at guard mounting. Practiced all the AM. Got a hard place to get over. Cleared off in the PM. Went over to the town serenading in the evening. Stopped first at a Mrs. Miles. Were invited in and met some of Ky's fairest daughters. We were treated in the best style by the beautiful and accomplished ladies of the house, the most lovely ladies, we have had the pleasure of meeting in Kentucky. We felt it was good for us to be there. We next went to Mr. Haycraft's, a fine old gentleman of wealth and influence. Were invited in. The old lady made us feel at once that we were at home. Were treated in good style. We then went to a Mr. Thomas'. There we found the most splendid mansion and surrounding yard I ever saw. The yard occupies several acres of ground and is shaded by the most beautiful evergreens and shade trees of all kinds with the finest graveled walk laid out in perfect order. We played several pieces and several ladies appeared on the balcony and waved the old flag, the stars and stripes. We gave them 3 hearty cheers. It was so late we were not invited in but the ladies sent out their cards of thanks. We then went to several other places and were handsomely received. They all seemed to enjoy and appreciate our style. We got back to camp at 1 o'clock having enjoyed the hospitality of the whole Kentuckians which every one knows the world can't beat. We found that our respected worthy friends also and thru whose hospitality we enjoyed at West Point had very kindly posted the good folks here in advance of us by sending word that there was nothing like the Mich. 9th and that the band were every one a gentleman. So we were not looked upon as heathens.

Jan. 16th Thursday

Quite cold. So we could not play at guard mounting. Received a letter from Sis and answered it. Wrote to Henry Willis. Went to town and got my boots. Played at dress parade. Did not feel well.

Jan. 17th Friday

A little warmer but still cloudy. Played at guard mounting. Practiced in the AM and PM. And at dress parade and in the evening at headquarters. Feel about used up. Have to take something I guess. Mud deep and growing deeper. Hope I'll get a letter tomorrow. Wonder if I will? Yes. Guess I will. George says he has quit chewing tobacco. We'll see.

Jan. 18th Saturday

Very rainy. Had a heavy thunder shower last night. Rained most all day. 2 Co.'s that were left at West Point rejoined us today. We went out to meet them. The mud was most up to one's knees and it was quite rainy but we played them through town in good shape regardless of mud and rain. The boys were quite wet and tired but were in good spirits. Received a letter from E.E. that I was looking for sometime. Also received one from sister E.A. full, as usual, of good words. 8 o'clock in the evening. It continues to rain most of the time.

Jan. 19th Sunday

Still raining 7:00 AM. Had the heaviest rain last night that I have witnessed in a great while. It poured down in torrents. The little creek that runs by here was very high in the morn. They had some fears for the railroad bridge, but it stood the pressure. Went to church in the AM. They had the poorest singing I ever heard. They are at least fifty years behind the times. It made me ache to sit and hear them squalling. The rain appeared to be over and it is quite warm as that a fire feels uncomfortable. Played at Dress Parade. Captain Newcombe came up from Nolin.

Jan. 20th Monday

Still cloudy. Had a heavy thundershower last night. Mud deeper than ever.

Jan. 21st Tuesday

Cloudy, but does not rain. We heard that Zollicoffer is dead. Our forces have had a skirmish with the rebels and whipped them and killing the General. Played at Dress Parade.

Jan. 22nd Wednesday

Still cloudy, no sunshine yet. Spent the day in digging ditches around our tents. Fixing a place for our cook. Got quite tired.

Jan. 23rd. Thursday

Still cloudy. The sun has not shone, but twice since the first day of this year. Two or three carloads of artillery passed here today. 1:00 PM -the sun shines for awhile. There seems to be a break in the clouds. Perhaps it is going to clear off. Played at Dress Parade.

Jan. 24th Friday

Pleasant. Very Pleasant. Not a cloud to observe. Clear sky, quite cool last night. Looks like good sugar weather. Thought I should get a letter today, but was disappointed. As we went out to practice this morning we saw a new regiment flag in front of headquarters. It was a beautiful one and some formed a circle around it. We played Star Spangled Banner. The colonel came out and cheered us. Several ladies visited our camp. We heard some firing in the direction of the lower bridge in the evening and fearing there might be trouble one company went down but found nothing out of place.

Jan. 25th Saturday

Quite windy, but not very cold. Fine winter weather. Went downtown to play a funeral dirge over the remains of a departed fellow soldier. Thus departs one who a few weeks ago was as healthy as anyone but he has gone and who is the next to go? Who? We played at Dress Parade. Our colonel was there. He has been away two weeks. Played at headquarters in the evening. Received a letter from home. What better than letters from friends far away.

Jan. 26th Sunday

Pleasant. Went to church at the Congregational Church in the AM. In the PM I went to the Baptist Church. Heard Captain Wilkinson of Company A preach. Sergeant Doolittle came up from Nolin. Spent the night with me. Played at Dress Parade. Several citizens of the town were present.

Jan. 27th Monday

Rainy and muddy. Snowed last night, but all melted off this morning. Very disagreeable all day. Went downtown in the PM to draw our beef, but it was so poor I would not take it. We needn't think that mule beef is good enough for soldiers. The thing won't go down. Had a spell of dum ague in the evening. Went to bed feeling as mean as an honest man ever ought to.

Jan. 28th Tuesday

Got up feeling pretty hard. Ate a mouthful of breakfast and played at Guard Mounting and then went to bed and slept all day. Felt pretty bad. Had an awful headache. Was afraid I was going to be sick. Had to let the band play for the first time without me. The wind blew almost a hurricane all day.

Jan. 29th Wednesday

Got up this morning feeling better. Played at Guard Mounting although not able. Rained hard in the night. Mud very deep. Rained most all day. Did no playing at all through the day. Wirts and I had a long practice in the evening on some tough pieces. It commenced to snow in the evening.

Jan. 30th Thursday

Cool, snow about two inches deep and still cloudy. The body of the rebel General Zollicoffer passed through here today. Wirts got up this morning and washed his face.

Jan. 31st. Friday

Cloudy in the morning, but cleared off fine before noon. Today is knapsack drill (inspection). Everyone must pack his knapsack, sling it, and proceed to the inspection ground after marching around a few times. We go through an inspection which is no very pleasant performance. Received a letter from Mr. ? Also one from sister, Elsie.

Feb. 1st Saturday

Cold and windy. Still too muddy to get around much. Sergeant Doolittle came up here. Played at Dress Parade and Headquarters in the morning.

Feb. 2nd. Sunday

Cloudy. Went to the Presbyterian Church in the AM. Very few out. Went to the Baptist Church in the PM. Had a full house. Captain Newcombe came up from Nolin and I went back with him. Had a fine singing in the evening. Found Company F in good quarters and enjoying life finely. They are encamped on sandy soil on the bank of the river.

Feb. 3rd Monday

Rained all night. The Captain and I slept on a single bed. Got along very well by spooning. Had a good visit with the boys. Took the cars for home at 2:00. Played at Dress Parade.

Feb. 4th Tuesday

Quite cool in the morning. Cleared off, pleasant. Looks like a storm at night. A company of Kentucky soldiers came out to see our Dress Parade. Wrote to E.E.W.

Feb. 5th Wednesday

Pleasant all day. Hathaway came up from Nolin. We raised a flag in camp this PM which we had presented to us. It is a fine large one. We played Star Spangled Banner as the flag went up. Then the Chaplain invoked a blessing upon our country, the flag, and ourselves. After which LT. Col. Parkhurst made a brief, but appropriate speech. We then played "Red, White, and Blue" then came the usual amount of cheering. All passed off pleasantly. Had a bad headache in the evening.

Feb. 6th Thursday

Rained all night very hard. Some rainy this morning, cleared off, pleasant. The regiment all practiced with blank cartridges. They make the hills and woods sing.

Feb. 7th. Friday

Cloudy all day. Received a letter from sister, Anna and read it. Also wrote home. Our regiment are burning lots of powder nowadays.

Feb. 8th. Saturday

Still cloudy and cool. Looks like snow. Got the blues this morning. It seems as though our armies were not doing anything and were not likely to. 10:00 PM feel a little better. Our fleet has captured Ft. Henry on the Tennessee River. Hope they will keep us on fire good work.

Feb. 9th Sunday

Clear and cold. The ground froze the hardest that it has for a long time. I hear the sad news this morning that Corporal Hadden died last night and is to be sent to Michigan today. Thus another fine fellow is sacrificed and another home made sad and lonely. We went down to play a dirge over his body. T was sad to see one that ten days ago was so well and cheerful put in the coffin and closed from site forever. Went to meeting in the AM. Dress Parade in the PM. Received a letter from? Glad to hear from her.

Feb. 10th Monday

Cold and clear in the morning, but clouded up. The ground remained frozen all day. Received a letter from A.G. and answered it.

Feb. 11th. Tuesday

The ground covered with snow and snowing yet. It looks like winter. Sad and lonely today and to add to our loneliness Corbus has just received the sad, sad news that his wife was dead and buried, poor fellow. He takes on like a child and well he may. His wife whom he left at home a few weeks ago well is now no more. He has no home. That was his all is no more. It seems as though he could not be reconciled to his lot but it was God's will let it be done.

Feb. 12th Wednesday

Warm and pleasant. Feel better this morning. Heard some good news from Burnside's expedition. Also, that General Buckner has retreated. Fort Henry is taken.

Feb. 13th. Thursday

Pleasant and warm. The bluebirds are singing and the mud is drying up. Had a long practice AM and PM went out to practice with my revolver. Made some very good shots think I could shoot a rebel twenty rods. Received a letter from home sweet home. There are lots of soldiers passing here. There will be something done soon. Had quite a number of visitors at our Dress Parade. The boys did first rate. Looks like a storm. Commenced rain in the evening.

Feb. 14th Friday

Cold, but clear about two inches of snow on the ground. Most froze last night, but then "who would not be a soldier".

Feb. 15th Saturday

Still and clear. The town presents quite a military appearance today. General Nelson and General McCook are here with their brigades about ten thousand soldiers passed through town, the rest go south. The two generals look like substantial men not likely to get frightened very easy. General Nelson's men go to West Point then down the river. There was to have been 40 steamers at West Point today. The fight at Fort Donaldson is going on finely.

Feb. 16th Sunday

Went to church in the forenoon and stayed at home in the afternoon. Our forces are making sad havoc at Fort Donaldson but have not yet got possession. The weather is a little warmer looks like rain.

Feb. 17th Monday

Rainy all day. Mud deep all day. Stayed in the tent most all day. The fight still continues at Fort Donaldson. Our troops have got possession of part of the Fort. 7:00 camp all in an uproar. The whole regiment are firing, drums are beating, and we are playing Star Spangled Banner. Fort Donaldson is taken with all it contained. Three or four Generals and 15,000 troops hurrah. Dick Wirts is making a great display. Savannah is also taken by our never to be conquered forces.

Feb. 18th Tuesday

The sun rose clear. The day, the loveliest of the season. Went downtown to get the papers and hear the news. Found the news of last night all correct. The rebels are sadly whipped in three or four engagements. Went downtown in the evening to serenade General Ward and others. Found one of the officers sick so we could not play for the General. Played at several other places. At a Mr. Helms, Mrs. Helms is a sister of "Abe Lincoln" President of the USA. Found them very intelligent and fine people. Had a fine chat with them. The express agent visited us and favored those that were found of such with some fine Peach Brandy.

Feb. 19th Wednesday

Very rainy. Rained hard in the night. Rained all day. It helps the mud that's all.

Feb. 20th Thursday

Pleasant all day. Went downtown to the funeral of Lt. Barshite and played. He is gone after an illness of only five days of the typhoid fever. The officers all turned out to pay their last respects to

the departed brother. His remains were sent to Michigan.

Feb. 21st. Friday

Read a letter from E.W. which did me good. Went down to see the 13th Michigan Regiment but they did not arrive. Saw a few of their band. Several of whom came up to our camp and were anxious that we should play for them but we were in such shape, we could not. Mrs. Moulton was sick. Corbus has gone home on a furlough.

Feb. 22nd. Saturday

Quite rainy. A train of 100 army wagons passed here this morning from Louisville. Rained all day. Wonder if old Jeff Davis is inaugurated President today? He must feel proud of his position. Had a bad headache in the evening.

Feb. 23rd. Sunday

Got up feeling pretty hard. Concluded that I had the ague last night. Stayed in the tent all day. Ate nothing.

Feb. 24th Monday

Don't seem to get any better feel sick. Wind blew a hurricane most all night.

Feb. 25th Tuesday

Very pleasant all day. The mud is drying up finely but I am too sick to enjoy anything. The doctor says I've got the mumps and I guess I have for my chops are sore enough. Received a letter from sister Em which does me some good.

Feb. 26th Wednesday

Pleasant. Had a heavy thundershower in the evening. Received a letter from Asaph.

Feb. 27th Thursday

Some cloudy. I am still on the feeble list. Hope I shall get out soon for it is dull business being shut up here.

Feb. 28th Friday

Quite pleasant. Today is review and general inspection but I cannot go out. Sick until March 9th. Went to the hospital the 4th and came out the 9th to get ready to march for West Point.

March 10th Monday

Quite rainy in the AM but cleared off in the PM and as no one came to take our place guarding the bridges. We did not leave. Am feeling pretty well only quite weak.

March 11th Tuesday

Were called up at 5:00 to pack up for a march to West Point. Got everything packed and ready to start at about 9 and ½ o'clock and bid adieu to Camp Haycraft and Elizabethtown forever. I hope the doctor thought I had better get into an ambulance and ride but I thought I would walk so I

started and walked 6 miles and then had to get on one of the teams and ride. The day was warm and pleasant. The roads dry and we had a very pleasant march. Camping at night. Slept on the bare ground, but was so tired that I slept very well.

March 12th Wednesday

Were call up at daylight. Got some coffee and packed up to march again. Felt pretty sore and stiff but started on foot and walked all day. Got to West Point at about 2:00. Pitched our tents in a meadow. Mud quite deep but was so tired that I found no trouble in sleeping anywhere.

March 13th Thursday

Got up feeling pretty well. Some sore. Got breakfast and went down town . Found things about as we left them 2 months before. Dull and lonesome Hope the boats that take us to Nashville will be here soon. Spent the day strolling around camp.

March 14th Friday

Rained all night and all day. Our camp is perfectly awful! Mud! Mud! Mud! Shall get homesick if we have to stay here. Rec'd a letter from E.E. and one from Mattie Stewart. Spent the morning with Capt. Newcombe singing. Stayed the night with him.

March 15th Saturday

Still rainy. Rained all night. The camp is so wet and muddy that lots of the boys are on the sick list. Went up town to get our rations. The Ohio and Salt river are rising fast. Things look dubious, gloomy but look here! There is a boat stopping and a man gets off with a substantial looking box. We don't have to wait long to know who it is for. In 5 minutes the whole camp are out giving 3 cheers for the pay master. Yes the man is here and we get our pay just in season. It does the boys good. We all sign the pay roll and the band went over and got their pay and return feeling like new men.

March 16th Sunday

Still cloudy. Mud growing deeper. Awful. It would take the pen of a poet to describe our camp but there is not so many sick. This morning because the paymaster is here. Went down town and got some maple sugar. Took dinner at the tavern. Hardly know how to act at a table. Came back to camp to wade in the mud.

March 17th Monday

Pleasant all day. Mud drying up.

March 18th Tuesday

Warm and pleasant. Went up on Muldraugh Hill in the PM to see Capt Lamphere parting. They rec'd us with a salute of 3 guns and brought forward some coffee and doughnuts which we could appreciate. After which we came down to WP and serenaded several places. Were invited in and treated in fine style. Got back to camp about 12 o'clock.

March 19th Wednesday

Got up early. Found it raining and a large boat in readiness to take us off. The boat (Jacob Strader) is a very large one. Big enough to take our whole regiment. We commenced to pack up and a muddy time we had. But got everything on board a little past 12 and then had to wait for the other boats.

March 20th Thursday

Waked up in the night. Found the boat in motion in the morning. Found the boat tied up to a tree 30 or 40 miles down the stream. The river so foggy, they could not run. But fog soon cleared off and we started down the river in company with 5 other boats. We made fine progress and reached Cannelton, Indiana by noon. It is a fine little place. We stopped to ? Up and we got a pass to go a shore but found the town as dry as a contribution box. Could not get as much as a newspaper. We did not get away until dark.

March 21st Friday

Rode all night. Did not see anything of interest. Most of the boys had to sleep on deck. But I got a chance in a bunk. About noon we reached the mouth of the Cumberland river. Here we saw some fortifications with a few troops. We did not stop. We saw some effects of war all along. The darkeys seemed to enjoy the fun finely. At dark, we drew up to the bank and tied up to a tree.

March 22nd Saturday

Took an early start this morning and soon reached Ft. Donaldson. Where we fought the glorious battle. We did not stop but could see the effects of a hard battle. Some large trees mowed down by cannon balls. We passed several other places that the rebels had fortified. At Clarksville, they had a strong place but had to leave before the terrible pressure bearing down on them. At night we halted where the banks were lined with cane breaks. Good place to get a fishing pole.

March 23rd Sunday

Started at daylight. Soon passed Ft. Zollicoffer. Quite a strong point but of no use. About 8 o'clock came in sight of Nashville. It took most all day to get unloaded but at 4 o'clock we went on shore and marched through the city, out 2 miles, and encamped. Got orders to get ready to march day after tomorrow to Murfreesboro.

March 24th Monday

A pretty cold night. Did not get any straw to sleep on, Commenced to cook rations for the march but got orders to stay where we were until further orders.

March 25^h Tuesday

Got a pass to go down town. Went to see the capitol. One of the finest in America.

March 26th Wednesday

Spent the day in camp. Getting quite warm. Peach and cherry trees are in bloom and the fields look quite green.

March 27th Thursday

Went to visit the sanitarium. A very pleasant place, beautifully layed out with streets and walks lined with beautiful evergreens.

March 28th Friday

Very warm. Getting quite dusty. Received a letter from Father. Received orders to march tomorrow morning.

March 29th Saturday

Got up at 5 AM and for enjoyment had to get breakfast and before I got the dishes washed, the tents were all struck and the men getting ready. We of course, as usual got our knapsacks into a wagon. Everything being ready, we started at 9 o'clock. We soon came to the camping grounds of the rebel army and a sad sight it was to some of the finest farms I ever saw spoiled by the miserable rascals. Some splendid houses, that were surrounded by beautiful shade trees are deserted and the shade and ornamental trees all cut down, fences all gone and nothing but desolation left. 8 miles out from Nashville is the insane asylum. A splendid and costly structure but the grounds are not yet finished. There are about 200 patients now in the asylum. Near the asylum is the Hermitage of Gen. Jackson. It is a beautiful palace and I do not wonder the old hero was attached to his home. We halted for dinner 9 miles from Nashville in a fine grove of large oaks in front of a house owned by a man in the rebel army. He is paying dearly for his whistle for his fine lands sadly defaced. 15 miles from Nashville we encamped for the night. Having passed over the finest country I ever saw. At night we encamped in a cotton field, the first I ever saw. We collected a few heads as specimens.

25

March 30th Sunday

The drums beat at 4 ½ o'clock and all hands are up and getting breakfast. That disposed of we gain precede. The country is not quite as good as it was yesterday. At noon we stopped at a nice stream of water with a large spring of cool water to fill our canteens at. Some of the boys indulged in a swim in the river. Our afternoon march through a delightful country, fine farms with lots of fruit trees, peach in particular. We had lots of fun with the contrabands. Some 15 to 20 of them followed us all afternoon and sang songs and danced plantations breakdowns. Quite a number of them wanted to go with us and we agreed to take one, set him to work at night getting supper. We camped at night beside a fine stream in a clover field. For variety we had to ford a small river in our afternoon march. The bridge being burned by the rebels but they are mistaken if they think that is going to stop the progress of the Yankee Army. We passed some large cotton fields. Cotton, wheat, and corn are the principal products.

March 31st Monday

Were up at daylight. Got some coffee and packed up again. Got started in good season. The boys are all feeling first rate just getting used to marching. We soon again came to a small river, where the bridge as usual is burned and we had to ford. The whole regiment took off their stockings and boots and waded in. On the opposite bank we encamped in a fine grove of oak trees, there to wait for further orders which came before dark. We are to move to the other side of town. We are met by Capt. Loomis and several other of his officers. One ruff old fellow on meeting one of our Capt that he was acquainted with, rushed up and threw his arms around his neck and kissed him.